

Quality Management System Manual

Example Ltd

ISO 9001:2015 · Stage 1 Foundation

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1. Quality Policy

At Example Ltd, our approach to quality is based on delivering building services installations that are correct and compliant from the outset. For us, quality is not an abstract measure but is directly visible in every job we hand over. This starts by ensuring that every installation, whether electrical or mechanical, meets or exceeds the client's specifications and passes inspection without the need for repeat work. We do not rely on a second chance to get it right — the installation must pass all commissioning and certification checks the first time.

We recognise that our clients, especially main contractors and public-sector bodies like schools and NHS sites, are under considerable programme pressures. Any slip in dates on live projects can have immediate, serious impacts on the client's operations. Our management and site teams work closely together to ensure our activities align with the master programme, giving the main contractor confidence that we will not be the cause of any delays. We continually monitor our performance against agreed programmes and proactively address any factors (such as late materials or resource shortages) that could impact delivery.

Accurate, timely documentation forms another pillar of our quality standards. Our process is structured so that electrical test certificates, commissioning records, and handover documentation are completed and signed off before we hand the job back — not as an afterthought. This ensures regulatory compliance (such as BS 7671) and avoids last-minute scrambles that can compromise quality. When paperwork is right at handover, our clients and their clients can trust that the job is fully compliant and ready to operate as intended.

We consider our reputation to be built on being a reliable, tidy subcontractor and partner — one that closes out work with minimal snagging, requires little chasing, and avoids callbacks for avoidable issues. Our processes are reviewed and updated regularly based on feedback from site operatives, clients, and main contractors. When snagging or recurrent concerns are identified, we do not merely fix the symptom but look to amend the underlying process, ensuring continual improvement.

Our directors and managers are accessible throughout each project, providing oversight and immediate support to the teams who carry out the work. Quality is not a static achievement but a daily discipline, reflected in everything from site briefings and toolbox talks to the rigorous review of completed job files. We express our commitment to quality by hitting programme dates, handing over jobs with a completed documentation pack, and reducing snagging to an absolute minimum across all our projects.

2. Quality Objectives

We measure quality within Example Ltd by clear, operationally relevant metrics that reflect client requirements, industry standards, and our own expectations as a subcontractor. Each objective is tracked, reviewed, and underpins decision-making at all levels.

- **Jobs completed to the agreed programme date:** Our aim is to increase the proportion of projects delivered on the scheduled date from the current average of approximately 80% to 95% by the end of 2026. Delays can disrupt not only our operations but also those of our main contractor clients and building occupiers, particularly on time-sensitive sites like schools and NHS facilities. Progress against this metric is reviewed monthly by site managers and office staff to identify any recurring causes of delay, such as supply chain inefficiencies or resource gaps, and corrective action is implemented as needed.
- **Snagging items raised at handover:** Our present average is around 20 items per job raised at handover; our target is to reduce this to an average of 10 or fewer by the end of 2026. This objective is tracked through internal snagging walkthroughs before client handover, and the nature of recurring snags is used to drive retraining or process changes as appropriate.
- **Commissioning/test packs fully completed at handover:** Achieving 100% of commissioning and test packs completed, checked, and signed at the time of handover (versus the current best level of around 60%) by end of 2026 is critical for compliance and customer satisfaction. On-site teams and administrative support receive regular reminders, and spot checks are conducted before handover deadlines to avoid paperwork being rushed or overlooked. Instances where test packs are missing or incomplete are formally reviewed, and corrective measures put in place.

3. Scope of the Quality Management System

The Quality Management System (QMS) at Example Ltd covers all our activities concerning the installation, commissioning, and maintenance of mechanical and electrical systems in commercial, educational, NHS, office, and light industrial buildings. The system applies to all directly employed staff and subcontracted operatives who work under our supervision and within our processes. Activities covered include tendering, project and resource planning, procurement of materials and services, on-site installation of mechanical (heating, pipework, HVAC controls) and electrical (distribution boards, containment, lighting, wiring) systems, all elements of testing and commissioning required for compliance, documentation management, corrective and preventive actions, and internal review processes.

Excluded from the QMS are any minor ancillary services not delivered by Example Ltd staff (such as services in scope for independent sub-contractors not managed or certified by us), and any activities beyond the geographical coverage of our business, which is primarily the West Midlands region with occasional travel for framework projects. The system is designed to fully encompass and demonstrate compliance with UK statutory requirements (CDM, BS 7671, Gas Safe), as well as client and main contractor requirements, especially in public-sector contracting environments.

4. Process Overview

The effective delivery of our projects relies on structured, interlinked processes encompassing leadership, core project execution, and essential support activities. Below is an overview of how these processes fit together and interact, ensuring delivery to programme, compliance, and continual improvement.

4.1 Leadership Processes

The leadership team, headed by Gareth Pryce (Owner / Managing Director), maintains oversight of all projects from pre-tender to handover. Process leadership begins with review and approval of all significant tenders, verifying that the scope, estimated resources, and regulatory obligations of the job are fully understood. On award of a contract, Gareth confirms key constraints and authorises project launch.

Monthly management meetings are held with the office manager and site manager to review progress of all live jobs, track KPI performance (such as on-time completion and snagging rates), and evaluate feedback received from clients and main contractors. The leadership sets priorities for corrective actions and may adjust resource allocation (for example, shifting personnel between jobs to respond to programme risks). Gareth or his delegate also leads periodic process reviews, assessing effectiveness of QMS procedures and updating them to reflect lessons learned from completed works or audit findings.

Escalations relating to non-conformance, incidents, or potential programme slippage are handled directly by the managing director, who coordinates a response involving affected site and office staff. Leadership is also responsible for ensuring the QMS remains aligned with changing regulatory frameworks and client requirements, commissioning external audits or training as necessary.

4.2 Core Processes

Our core project delivery process begins with the successful award of a contract. The office manager prepares and circulates the project documentation, which sets out the programme, resource plan, and Risk Assessments and Method Statements (RAMS). Joanne Clarke prepares initial procurement schedules in consultation with Lee Hammond, the site manager. Early procurement triggers supplier engagement and booking of plant/equipment timed for site requirements. Lee carries out mobilisation briefings with the installation crew, outlining the scope of works and key programme dates.

Installation activities are executed on site by small teams under Lee's direction, working strictly to the approved drawings and specifications. Each trade stage (first fix, second fix, final fix) culminates in an inspection and sign-off before proceeding. Lee coordinates day-to-day progress, regularly updating Joanne on the need for additional or missing materials. Electrical testing to BS 7671 and commissioning of mechanical systems are scheduled in sequence with completion of physical installation tasks, ensuring no test is missed due to site constraints or resource clashes.

Prior to handover, Lee conducts a snagging walkthrough, raising any issues internally before the client or main contractor's walkdown. Completion and assembly of test certificates, commissioning records, and O&M information is coordinated by both site and office staff, so that the handover pack is ready and signed off before the completion meeting. Any missing items are flagged immediately for rectification rather than left unresolved. The close-out meeting and final documentation handover involve both site and office input, ensuring everything is present and accurate.

The process for corrective actions is initiated as soon as any issue is reported, either externally by the client or internally by staff. Joanne records the issue and notifies Gareth for review. Lee investigates the cause on site, determining whether an immediate fix is possible or if operational changes are required. All corrective works are assigned and tracked until resolution; recurring or high-risk issues prompt a process review, with management involved in updating work instructions or training as needed.

4.3 Support Processes

Material and equipment procurement is centralised through Joanne, who acts on schedules issued by Lee. Orders are placed with preferred suppliers, and confirmations obtained. All deliveries to site are checked on arrival by the crew against the delivery note and required specification; any discrepancies are reported to Joanne for follow-up with the supplier. When plant or equipment (particularly test instruments) are hired or sent for recalibration, records are maintained by Ricky Obeng to ensure up-to-date certification is in place before site use.

Ricky is also responsible for ensuring all operatives' qualifications (CSCS, ECS cards, Gas Safe registration) remain valid. The tracking system flags upcoming expirations, prompting notification to the relevant operative and arranging renewals where needed. Joanne manages job tracking software for project records, quotes, and invoicing, ensuring all job data and documentation are up to date and accessible for both current works and audit purposes.

Annual informal supplier reviews are carried out, generally before renewal of key accounts, to assess reliability in delivery and material quality. Any supplier consistently failing to meet expectations is discussed at management review and alternatives are identified where necessary.

Site waste management is handled via licensed contractors, with the main office verifying all relevant licenses are current and skips are changed as needed. Documentation such as CDM compliance paperwork is completed and filed for jobs where Example Ltd acts as principal contractor or designer.

Internal communication is facilitated through scheduled meetings and ad hoc briefings, with lessons learned shared to embed continuous process improvement across both field and office teams.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Gareth Pryce, Owner / Managing Director, is ultimately accountable for the effectiveness of the QMS. He oversees all project wins, approves critical operational decisions, manages major escalations (including client complaints, significant non-conformances, or health and safety breaches), and ensures resourcing is sufficient to meet project and compliance obligations. Gareth actively reviews project KPIs and instigates root cause analysis for jobs that miss key targets. He personally signs off process changes, appoints individuals to key QMS support roles, and leads annual management reviews.

Lee Hammond, as Site Manager, supervises all aspects of site execution. He leads daily briefings, inspects work at each stage, and ensures installation follows RAMS, specifications, and programme milestones. Lee communicates promptly with Joanne regarding procurement issues and flags resource or material risks to Gareth. He is the first escalation for on-site issues and is responsible for ensuring snag lists are closed before client handovers.

Joanne Clarke, Office Manager, manages all administration supporting the QMS. She coordinates procurement, maintains job files, tracks handover documentation, and is responsible for logging non-conformances and corrective actions. Joanne maintains internal records for supply chain management and works closely with both Gareth and Lee to ensure the job database is accurate and documentation is finalised before project closure.

Ricky Obeng, as Plant and Equipment Controller, maintains calibration records, manages plant and equipment allocation, and oversees the operatives' qualification tracking system. He ensures all relevant test equipment is in-date and compliant with regulatory requirements before it is assigned to a project. Ricky promptly flags upcoming certification expiries to both the relevant operative and Joanne so renewal can be arranged without delaying site activity.

All site operatives and apprentices are required to work to approved methods, comply with RAMS and site briefings, and report any concerns or deviations promptly to Lee. Everyone in the business is encouraged to suggest improvements and report potential or actual non-conformities.

The QMS is overseen collectively. While Gareth holds formal responsibility at director level, process ownership is practically shared between management and key operational staff. In the absence of any named quality manager, Gareth acts as the quality management system lead.

6. Document Control Procedure

All documented information relevant to the QMS is maintained on the company's secure digital system, which is accessible to authorised staff via password-protected computers in the main office. Joanne has responsibility for creating, updating, and controlling all internal forms, job records, RAMS, commissioning and test packs, and project correspondence. Each document is assigned a version number, issue date, and responsible person sign-off.

When a document is created (such as a new form or updated RAMS), Joanne uploads it to the shared drive under the controlled directory structure. She notifies affected staff when new versions become available. Obsolete documents are marked as "Superseded" and separated in a non-editable archive folder, with restricted permissions to prevent accidental use. Printed copies of controlled documents are issued on a limited basis, stamped "Controlled Copy," and tracked in a simple log. Any amendments are communicated at site or office meetings to avoid confusion about current versions in active use.

Job and project documentation (drawings, specs, certificates) are retained for at least six years post-handover, or longer when required by contract or statutory obligation. All records can be traced to project, client, and responsible staff. Joanne routinely audits the active directory to ensure no documents have been tampered with or lost. Should errors or omissions be detected, she reports the issue directly to Gareth for review and correction.

7. Internal Audit Procedure

An internal audit schedule is maintained and reviewed semi-annually by Gareth in consultation with Joanne. The aim is to sample key QMS processes (planning, procurement, installation, handover, and corrective action handling) at least once per year or more often if there have been significant changes, recurring issues, or feedback from clients requiring attention.

The audit is triggered according to the published schedule, or sooner if a major non-conformance is reported. Before each audit, Gareth briefs the audit team (usually himself and an appropriate staff member not responsible for the day-to-day running of the target process). The auditor reviews relevant documentation and records, then conducts interviews with operational staff (onsite and in the office) to verify correct process execution.

Deviations are logged, and corrective actions are agreed at the closing meeting. Deadlines and responsible persons are specified. Follow-up audits are scheduled to confirm the closure of corrective actions. Audit records are maintained by Joanne, with summaries and actions reviewed at management review meetings. The audit process, findings, and learnings are shared with the wider team to support continual improvement.

8. Management Review Procedure

The management review is conducted annually and scheduled by Gareth, with attendance from Joanne and Lee as core participants; Ricky and other key operatives may be invited based on agenda topics. The review covers performance against quality objectives, analysis of non-conformances and corrective actions, audit findings, customer feedback, resource adequacy (staff, suppliers, equipment), supplier performance, and regulatory compliance (updating for any new statutory obligations or standards).

The review is prepared by compiling data from project records, audit findings, and KPI dashboards. Gareth presents a written summary of objectives performance, identifies risks and improvement opportunities, and assesses client and main contractor feedback for trends. If targets are missed, contributing factors are discussed in depth and actions assigned with deadlines.

Outcomes include updating or adding objectives, authorising process changes, and allocating additional resources if required. Minutes are recorded by Joanne and actions tracked through to closure at subsequent meetings. Management review outputs may also trigger staff training, supplier changes, or investment in new equipment or technology.

9. Continuous Improvement Procedure

The company's approach to continual improvement is driven by regular process reviews, lessons-learned sessions, and the systematic analysis of feedback and non-conformance data. Improvement opportunities may be triggered by any of the following: internal audit findings, repeated snagging items, delayed handovers, incomplete test packs, external feedback from clients or main contractors, or recurring supply chain or resource issues.

When improvement is required, Gareth commissions a process review session involving relevant staff from site and office. Specific process weaknesses are mapped, root causes are analysed (often using simple tools such as Five Whys), and proposed changes are drafted. Trial changes are piloted on one project where appropriate, before wider implementation. Joanne updates all affected documented procedures and formally communicates changes to the team.

Lessons learned are shared at monthly meetings, and staff are encouraged to highlight inefficiencies and suggest adjustments to the way jobs are planned, sequenced, or documented. Where improvements are effective, they are locked into procedure and tracked for ongoing effectiveness, with periodic spot checks carried out to confirm sustained benefits.

For significant process improvements or investments (e.g., introducing new software), a brief business case is prepared for Gareth's approval. Corrective and preventive actions are recorded and reviewed, ensuring learning is embedded across the business rather than restricted to individual jobs or teams. The goal is a working environment where operational discipline, efficiency, and reliability grow with each contract delivered.